# Recycling Day 2025 Report

**Date:** September 29, 2025
**Location:** UBT Corniche Campus
**Organized by:** UBT Sustainability Club
**Theme:** *"Trash is Only Waste if You Waste It"*
**Aligned with:** UN SDGs (12 – Responsible Consumption & Production, 13 – Climate Action) & PRME Principles
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## Objectives




The purpose of Recycling Day was to provide students with a clear and engaging demonstration of how sustainability can be applied in everyday life. While environmental issues are often discussed in theoretical terms, our goal was to make the concept of recycling **visible, interactive, and practical** for the UBT community. The event aimed to address three key objectives:

1. To raise awareness about the **environmental impact of daily waste**, including how small changes in behavior can make a big difference.
2. To promote sustainable alternatives and highlight UBT's role as a leader in sustainability-driven education.
3. To encourage **student ownership and participation** in sustainability initiatives, ensuring that the experience felt collaborative and empowering rather than top-down.

By focusing on these objectives, Recycling Day became more than just an information campaign—it became a campus-wide experience where students saw, learned, and committed to change.

## Activities

### 1. Awareness Booth (Info Desk)




At the entrance to the Corniche campus, our central booth served as the information hub for the event. Here, students could scan **QR codes** that linked to the club's social media accounts, new member registration form, and a specially designed digital brochure that summarized the theme of Recycling Day. The brochure highlighted both global statistics—such as the fact that recycling one ton of paper saves 17 trees and 7,000 gallons of water—and local actions UBT students could take on campus. This booth provided a direct link between **awareness and action**, giving students the tools to get involved instantly.

### 2. Recycling Station

One of the most popular features was the recycling station, which showcased **real items from daily student life**—such as coffee cups, plastic bottles, and paper sheets—and demonstrated where they belonged in the recycling system. This visual, hands-on activity helped clarify common misconceptions (for example, which cups are recyclable and which are not) and allowed students to practice sorting items. By interacting with tangible examples, students walked away with a **practical understanding of recycling**, not just abstract knowledge.

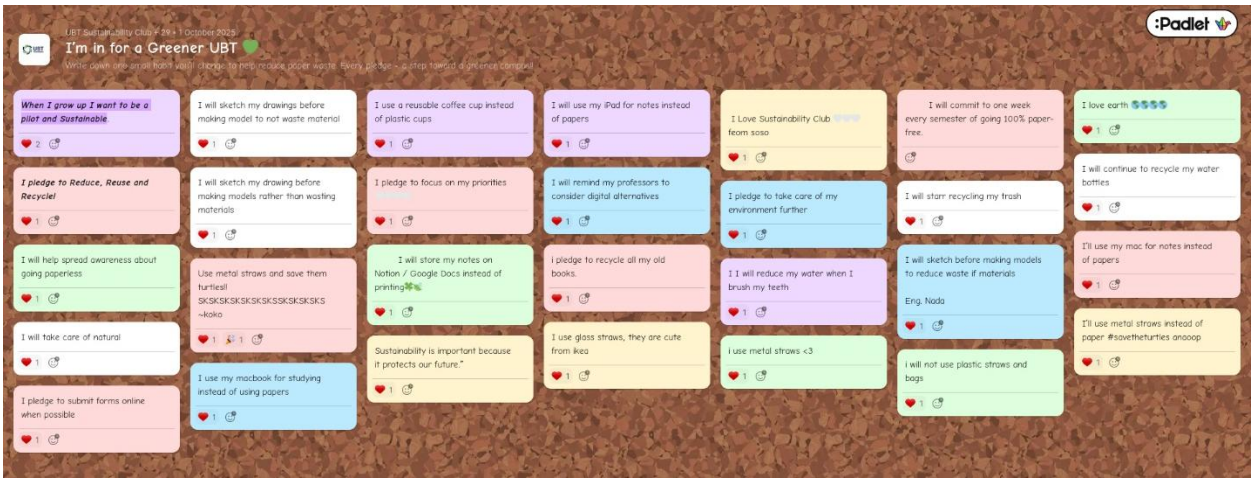
## 3. Origami Station




To emphasize creativity and reuse, the club collected waste printer paper from faculty offices and transformed it into a teaching resource. Students were guided to make origami models, showing how paper waste could be **repurposed rather than discarded**. This activity added an element of playfulness while reinforcing the idea that sustainability does not always require expensive solutions—it can begin with something as small as reimagining "waste" as material for learning and creativity.

## 4. Digital Pledge Wall

The pledge wall became the emotional centerpiece of the event. Using a digital platform, students were invited to write down one specific action they would commit to—such as carrying a reusable bottle, avoiding single-use straws, or remembering to sort their trash. These pledges were then displayed digitally, creating a shared sense of accountability. To reinforce



participation, each pledge was rewarded with a small treat (a cupcake or brownie). The activity was simple, but its symbolic power made it a highlight of the day: students could see in real time that **individual commitments add up to collective impact**.

## Communication & PR

The Sustainability Club used a **multi-platform communication strategy** to ensure that Recycling Day reached both on-campus participants and the wider online community.

- **Before the Event**: Posters with the theme *"Trash is Only Waste if You Waste It"* were placed around campus, featuring QR codes for details. Teasers on Instagram and TikTok. (Check it Out Here)
- **After the Event**: A recap reel was published across Instagram, TikTok, and LinkedIn, summarizing the energy and learning of the day. In just 24 hours, the video received over **2,000 views and 190+ likes**, showing that the event's impact extended well beyond the physical booth. (Check it Out Here)

This combination of in-person engagement and online amplification positioned Recycling Day as a **hybrid awareness campaign**—one that was equally effective on campus and in digital spaces.

### Participation & Impact

Recycling Day succeeded in mobilizing a diverse cross-section of the UBT community. A total of **16 volunteers** managed various booths, stations, and social media documentation. Over **150 students** interacted with the event, either by visiting the booths, engaging with the pledge wall, or participating in origami.

The measurable outcomes were significant:

- **50 student pledges** committed to sustainable habits.
- **5 new members** formally registered to join the Sustainability Club.
- The club's social media gained **50 new followers**, expanding its reach for future initiatives.

Beyond numbers, the **qualitative feedback** was equally important. Students expressed surprise at learning where common items should be recycled, excitement over the creative origami activity, and pride in making a visible pledge. Comments like *"I finally understood where to put my coffee cup"* or *"This made me realize sustainability can be fun"* highlighted the event's success in blending **education with engagement**.

## Budget & Resources




The event was designed to be **low-cost but high-impact**, reflecting the principle that sustainability should be resource-efficient.

- Cupcakes: ~500 SAR (with sustainability messaging included).
- Other materials—such as sample waste for the recycling station and origami paper—were collected from faculty offices and volunteers, with **zero additional cost**.

Total estimated cost: **500 SAR**.
This budget-friendly model demonstrated that effective sustainability engagement does not depend on large funds but on **creativity, planning, and collaboration**.

## Alignment with PRME & SDGs

Recycling Day was explicitly aligned with global frameworks:







- **SDG 12 (Responsible Consumption & Production):** Students actively practiced sorting and reusing waste, making responsible consumption habits tangible.
- **SDG 13 (Climate Action):** By linking recycling to climate benefits, the event showed how everyday habits contribute to climate resilience.
- **PRME Principles:**
  - *Purpose*: Encouraged students to lead responsibly by making personal pledges.
  - *Method*: Used interactive teaching methods (origami, pledges, recycling practice).
  - *Values*: Reinforced ethics of sustainability through action-oriented learning.
  - *Partnership*: Collaboration with local vendors and faculty highlighted how sustainability requires shared responsibility.

## Conclusion

Recycling Day 2025 at UBT proved that even a single-day initiative can create meaningful awareness, participation, and momentum when executed with creativity and purpose. The event succeeded not only in teaching the community about recycling but also in encouraging personal commitments and expanding the visibility of UBT's sustainability movement.

The combination of interactive stations, digital pledges, creative reuse, and multimedia storytelling turned the event into a strong case study of how student-led initiatives can embody PRME principles in action. Recycling Day will serve as a foundation for future projects, inspiring deeper integration of sustainability into campus culture and beyond.